



Government of Himachal Pradesh
State Disaster Management Authority

SCHEME FOR PROMOTING **AMATEUR (HAM)** AND **COMMUNITY RADIOS** FOR "ALTERNATE COMMUNICATION DURING EMERGENCIES"

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES



Government of Himachal Pradesh
Department of Revenue (Disaster Management)

No. Rev(DMC)(F)4-2/2000/SEC

Dated: Shimla-2, the 13th October 2023

NOTIFICATION

The Governor, Himachal Pradesh is pleased to notify Scheme for promoting Amateur and Community Radios (HAM) for "Alternate Communication during Emergencies" as provided under Section 22 sub-section(p) of Disaster Management Act, 2005 and as per the provisions of Section 3.6.1(x) and Section 6.12.1 of H.P. State Disaster Management Policy 2011. This scheme is to promote alternate means of communication for Emergencies and Disasters through HAM and Community Radios, identification of volunteers and HAM operators and their Training and Capacity Building.

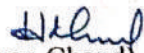
The detailed scheme guidelines are enclosed.

By order
Onkar Chand Sharma
Principal Secretary(Rev-DM) to the
Government of Himachal Pradesh.
Dated:- 13th October 2023

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Copy for information and necessary action to the following:-

1. All Administrative Secretaries to the Government of Himachal Pradesh.
2. Director General of Police, Himachal Pradesh.
3. All Heads of Departments in Himachal Pradesh.
4. All Deputy Commissioners-cum-Chairman, DDMA's in HP.
5. The Director, HP Institute of Public Administration, Fairlawns, Simla-12.
6. The Controller of P&S, HP for publication in Gazette.
7. Guard File.


(Balwan Chand)
Joint Secretary(Rev-DM) to the
Government of Himachal Pradesh.

SCHEME FOR PROMOTING AMATEUR (HAM) AND COMMUNITY RADIOS FOR "ALTERNATE COMMUNICATION DURING EMERGENCIES"

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES

1. Background

1.1 Himachal Pradesh is prone to 25 of the 33 total hazards identified in the country by the High-Powered Committee constituted by the Government of India in 2001. The State is mainly vulnerable to hazards such as, earthquakes, landslides, cloudbursts, flashfloods, fires, road accidents, etc. According to the seismic zonation map of the country, wherein the country has been categorized in zone II to Zone V and where zone II is least seismically active area and zone V is seismically highly active area, the State falls in Zone IV and V. The State has been shaken by many earthquakes in the past and 1905 Kangra earthquake was strongest ever recorded earthquake in the history of earthquakes in State. This earthquake led to the death of around 20,000 people and more than one lakh houses got collapsed. Since then the State has been shaken by more than 279 times by earthquakes of magnitude 3 and above in the Richter Scale. The 1975 Kinnaur earthquake was another big jolt which the State experienced. As per the many research outcomes, strong earthquake in this part of the Himalayas in the near future cannot be ruled out as no major earthquake has shaken this place for long.

1.2 Besides the earthquakes, the State has experienced severe flash floods and consequent damage in the year 2000, 2005 and 2013 in the Kinnaur district. Majority of the areas of the State are prone to landslides of varying degree. In the monsoon season of 2019, more than 500 landslides were experienced along the State roads alone and around 32 events of cloudburst were reported.

1.3 Management of any disaster or emergency event is a complicated and multi-faceted task. One of the most important and often overlooked parts of any efficient disaster response is effective information exchange between information sources, emergency managers and those impacted by the disaster or emergency event.

2. Communication during Emergencies

2.1 Communication system is the first casualty in the affected area during disaster. Due to the natural calamity, any one or a few or the entire communication network infrastructure may be totally affected depending on the damage caused by the calamity. In the worst-case scenario, the whole communication network might get broken down and the district and state response system may be at loss to know what exactly is happening (about the extent of damage, etc.) and what exactly is required for taking relief measures.

2.2 There are significant layers of vulnerabilities that have exposed the people of the State to natural and human induced hazards. Some of these vulnerabilities are created due to the geophysical peculiarities of the State, such as:

- Physical isolation and tough terrain
- Scattered human settlements in villages and hamlets
- Inadequate road connectivity to villages

- Inadequate network of telecommunication
- Harsh climatic conditions
- Fragile eco-system

2.3 In Himachal Pradesh there are far flung areas which usually gets disconnected during monsoons, snowfall or any extreme weather event. There are many blackout zones where there is no communication like Manali-Keylong-Leh and Kinnaur-Pooh-Kaza-Keylong highways where alternate medium of effective emergency communication channels are required to be developed. Establishing communication with remote areas has been a great challenge and with the advent of satellite communication, the problem of connectivity to remote and far flung areas is being gradually addressed. In times of crisis and disasters, Amateur Radio is often used as a means of emergency communication when wireline, cell phones and other conventional means of communications fail. Unlike commercial systems, Amateur Radio is usually independent of terrestrial facilities that can fail. It is dispersed throughout a community without "choke points" such as cellular telephone sites that can be overloaded.

2.4 A wireless communication network through Amateur Radio is one of the most effective and alternate mediums of communication and can play a significant role in providing reliable communications when other normal communications fail. The skills of the trained Amateur Radio operator can be used for public service in times of need and emergencies. In numerous occasions, under extreme circumstances, very efficient amateur radio communication and humanitarian assistance was provided by Ham Operators particularly during Orissa Super Cyclone-1999, Gujarat Earthquake-2001, Indian Ocean Tsunami- 2004, Aila cyclone-2009, Krishna floods-2009, Uttarakhand Floods 2012 and recently in Phallin&Fani Cyclones in Odisha and many other disasters/ calamities in the country. In times of crisis and disasters, Amateur Radio is often used as a means of emergency communication when wireline, cell phones and other conventional means of communications fail.

3. Amateur Radio (HAM)-As an alternative communication layer for DM

3.1 Amateur Radio is popularly known as "Ham Radio". Amateur Radio operators use two-way radio stations and communicate with others, similarly authorized, using various modes of communication like voice, Morse code, computers, internet, etc. The things that Amateur Radio operators do with their radios are as diverse as the people themselves. The advanced Amateur Radio communication techniques include Automatic Position Reporting Systems using GPS information, internet linking of repeater stations, interface with internet for exchange of emails, images, etc, as well as visual communication modes.

3.2 Amateur Radio (HAM) is both a hobby activity and service. It is an activity of self-learning, inter-communication & technical investigation carried on by duly authorized persons (ie. Amateur Radio Operators) for a personal aim and without pecuniary interest. There are over 30 lakh people all over the world who pursue this activity in their free time. In India we have around 15000 Amateur Radio operators.

3.3 During monsoon and winter season in the State there are several areas where communication fails specially in remote areas of Lahaul & Spiti, Chamba & Kinnaur districts. Besides, there are many locations in other districts where communication is a challenge. This poses a great challenge

in responding to any emergency situation. Therefore, the Chief Secretary while reviewing the winter preparedness in the state in meeting held on 15 November 2018 directed to explore the Ham Radios as one of the layers of emergency communication in each Sub-Division, so that fail-safe communication can be ensured during emergency situations.

4. Need of HAM Radio & its Strengthening

4.1 Ham Radio operators come in all ages and from all lifestyles and are essentially neighbors in the community. Each licensee passes one or more extensive knowledge tests covering a multitude of topics, including the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) rules, operator and station license responsibilities, operating procedures and practices, radio propagation, electrical principles and electronic circuits, common transmitter and receiver problems, antenna measurements and troubleshooting, basic repair and testing, non-voice communications, antennas and feed lines, AC power circuits, and safety.

4.2 Amateur radio operators are experienced in improvising antennas and power sources and most equipment today can be powered by an automobile battery. Annual "Field Days" are held in many countries to practice these emergency improvisational skills. Amateur radio operators can use hundreds of frequencies and can quickly establish networks tying disparate agencies together to enhance interoperability. Amateur radio operators have played a vital role during disasters and national emergencies such as earthquakes, tsunamis, cyclones, floods, and bomb blasts, by providing voluntary emergency communications in the affected areas. Therefore, strengthening this network in State like ours is all the more important.

5. Community Radio & its Strengthening

5.1 Besides, the Community Radio can play a vital role in achieving communication & IEC activities in their areas for disaster preparedness and response. Since this is perceived to be an enabling tool for building capacities of the local communities to own and manage it, this would serve their information and communication needs in a sustainable manner. Community radio combined with the village information centers could help a lot in creating location specific disaster mitigation strategies.

5.2 When a major disaster occurs in Japan, community radios play the role of disaster radios and emergency disaster radios are set up in the affected areas. In this way, victims can obtain the information, they need to overcome the disaster. Besides what has already been said, the role of community radios in disaster management is not confined to providing disaster information only. The presence of the community radio in every phase of a disaster: 'disaster mitigation', 'preparation', 'early warning', 'response', recovery and revitalization", is essential for the exchange and sharing of information and dialogue among residents, as well as the enhancement the community's capability and of self- government ability. In 2011 triple disaster of Japan, in the worst-affected areas, many internet servers were damaged. And often even where the internet could still be accessed, many of those over 60 years did not know how to use it. As a result, community radio stations were essential for survival and other information in these neighborhoods. During the first fortnight of the disaster, when no other information source was available, the audience numbers for local radio stations peaked.

5.3 In December 2002, the government of India released a policy that allowed well established educational institutions to set up community radios. In order to promote development and social change, the government of India in November 2006, implemented new Community Radio Guidelines permitting Non-Profit Organizations (NGOs) to own and operate community radio stations. With the new policy in place, it opened doors for community radio as a platform for development, social change and voice of the community in question. Union Government plans to bring to bring up the number of Community Radio Stations in India up to 4000. As per annual report of the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, Government of India (2018-19) so far, Letters of Intent (LoI) have been issued to 583 applicants. Out of 583 LoI holders, 323 have signed Grant of Permission Agreements (GOPA). About 275 new applications are presently under consideration for permission to set up Community Radio Station. There are 247 Community Radio Stations have become operational in the country, out of which, 110 are operated by civil societies, 122 by educational institutions and 15 by KrishiVigyanKendras (KVKs). These numbers speak of a huge scope for the Community Radio Movement in India.

5.4 Community radio is proven to be an effective tool for disaster management, as it has been the most efficient means to deliver information, that are suited to the needs of the community and packaged in their own language. It has helped build awareness and strategies so that the communities are better prepared and are able to participate more actively in disaster management. Community radios have played a big role in disaster management in Indonesia, Japan and Nepal as these countries are highly prone to disasters.

5.5 In 2004 when tsunami struck India, Anna FM was the only functional Community Radio Station in the region. The Radio Station played a big role in assisting the affected communities in these times of distress. Though, by law the community radio station wasn't allowed to broadcast any news or current affairs, but considering the occasion called for such a decision, they decided to act immediately and lend their support to the victims. Student volunteers were sent out as reporters to the disaster struck areas. The community Radio station acted as a platform for the victims to voice their grievances. They broadcasted information about relief material and likely outbreaks of epidemics.

6. Legal Provisions

6.1 The main responsibility for disaster management lies with the State Government and availability of last mile connectivity plays a crucial role in effective and efficient Disaster Management. Presently, the last mile connectivity exists for approximately 60% of villages through Public / Private network coverage. In a couple of years, it is expected to cover 95% of the villages in the Indian Sub-Continent. However, the existing last mile connectivity is likely to suffer damage during disaster situation. (Source: National Disaster Management Guidelines on National Disaster Management Information and Communication System 2012). Some legal provisions casting responsibility on State Government are as under:-

- i. Section 22 Sub Section (p) of the DM Act 2005 envisages that State Executive Committee and SDMA may "Ensure that communication systems are in order and the disaster management drills are carried out periodically".

- ii. Section 8.3 of National Disaster Management Guidelines - National Disaster Management Information and Communication System: In the aftermath of a disaster, the live Points of Presence (POPs) need to be integrated with mobile transportable networks engineered. This also includes integration of ham radios and any other communication resources, be it from para military forces, police or defence forces.
- iii. Section 3.6.1 (x) of HP State DM Policy 2011: Objectives of the DM Policy articulates, "Developing contemporary forecasting and early warning systems backed by responsive and fail-safe communication with information technology support."
- iv. Section 6.12.1 of HP State DM Policy 2011: Setting up and Strengthening of Emergency Operations Centres in State and Districts articulates: "The EOC's would have fail-safe communication network with multiple levels of built-in redundancy having communication to ensure voice, data and video transfer. *Development of Ham Radios network in the state would be encouraged so that it can be utilised during emergency. For last mile connectivity and control of the operations at the disaster hit areas, availability of portable platforms will be catered for.*"
- v. EOC Manual developed by HPSDMA 2011 & 2016: EOCs at all levels shall have a fail proof communication network with triple redundancy of NICNET of NIC, POLNET of Police and SPACENET of ISRO in addition to the terrestrial and satellite-based communication to ensure voice, data and video transfer. The MHA had circulated a suggestive list of equipment for EOC which includes one set of Ham Radio at each EOC.
- vi. Priority 4 of Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015- 2030: To invest in, develop, maintain and strengthen people-centered multi-hazard multisectoral forecasting and early warning systems, disaster risk and emergency communications mechanisms social technologies and hazard-monitoring telecommunications systems; develop such systems through a participatory process; tailor them to the needs of users, including social and cultural requirements, in particular gender: promote the application of simple and low-cost early warning equipment and facilities; and broaden release channels for natural disaster early warning information.

7. Vision of the Scheme

7.1 To promote alternate means of communication for Emergencies and Disasters through HAM & Community Radios in accordance with the Government of India's Policies & Guidelines for HAM Radios and Community Radios.

8. Activities in the Scheme

8.1 Key activities to be undertaken under this Scheme would be as under:-

- a) Identification of volunteers & existing Ham operators
- b) Training & Capacity Building of the interested volunteers/Government officials/NGOs in HAM Radio
- c) Promotion of HAM Radio through Police volunteers
- d) Interested Volunteer official/officer from DC Offices will be given support for taking up HAM Radio as an incentive-based activity.
- e) Providing support to conduct examination in the State for Ham Operators.

- f) Licensing support to active and enthusiastic Hams who will help DDMA and SDMA for emergency communication during or post disasters.
- g) Tateralter Resilient India by building preparedness at all levels.
- h) Subsidization in the cost of basic HAM equipment.
- i) Establishment of Ham Radio Clubs in education institutions etc. in the State for promotion of Ham Radios.
- j) Deployment of HAM operators during emergency in affected areas j) Deployment of one HAM each in all EOCs
- k) Strengthening of the Community Radios and networking thereof
- l) Promotion of Disaster Risk Reduction through Community Radio
- m) Ensuring the possibility in how the Community radios can help or assist in the immediate relief of those affected by disasters.
- n) Preparation and broadcasting of pre-recorded emergency response announcements
- o) Broadcasting of Dos & Don'ts of various hazards
- p) Regular Communication Mock drills
- q) Database development and linking of societies

9. Coverage of the Scheme

9.1 All the 12 districts of Himachal Pradesh. The Education Institutions will also be encouraged to create HAM Radio Clubs.

10. Knowledge Partners

10.1 Key knowledge partners who will help ground the Scheme will be as under :-

- i. National Disaster Management Authority
- ii. Wireless and Planning and Coordination Wing (WPC), New Delhi
- iii. HAM Radio Society, NIT Hamirpur
- iv. National Institute of Amateur Radio (NIAR), Hyderabad
- v. Amateur Radio Society of India (ARSI), Bangalore.
- vi. Existing Community Radios in the State
- vii. Himachal Institute of Public Administration (HIPA)
- viii. Police Department
- ix. HPSDMA & All the DDMA

11. Funding of the Programme

11.1 The HPSDMA will provide the funds under the State Disaster Response Funds Capacity Building Grant under 15 FC funds or other funds available with HPSDMA under any other head or project to run the Scheme

11.2 Funds may also be obtained from other sources such as Govt. of India Scheme(s), Corporate Social Responsibility, other donor agencies, etc.

12. Financial Norms: The Scheme will have the following financial norms:

Sr. No.	Scheme Component	Financial Norms
1	a) Identification of the HAM Volunteers b) Registration c) Training on HAM Radio d) Conduct of Examination for interested volunteers. e) Licensing for HAM Volunteers	The cost of these activities will be borne as per actual basis by the HPSDMA.
2	Purchase of HAM Equipment	80% cost of the equipment will be supported by the HPSDMA subject to maximum of Rs. 60,000/- per beneficiary (One-time expenditure). ii. 20% cost of the equipment will be borne by the applicant
3	a) Setting up of new Ham Radio Clubs in Education Institutions b) Strengthening of existing Ham Radio Clubs c) Training & Capacity building of the Ham Radio Clubs	The cost of these activities will be borne by the HPSDMA as per the norms approved by the State Executive Committee constituted under the Disaster Management Act, 2005.
4	Training & Capacity Building of Community Radio Operators & Community Members/Volunteers in disasters	
5	Advertisements for IEC on various The cost of advertisement will be borne by the HPSDMA/DDMA/ other Departments as per IPR rates.	The cost of these trainings will be borne by HPSDMA as per actuals

13. Application/Agreement with Ham Radio Volunteer

13.1 Interested volunteer will apply to HPSDMA in the prescribed form (Annexure 1) and give undertaking to act as volunteer and provide his/her services to the HPSDMA during emergencies & disasters/ disaster situation.

14. Target

14.1 It is envisaged to create at least one HAM Radio Volunteer in each Sub- Division of the State, so that in case of emergency/ disasters, alternate communication channel can be created at Sub-Division Level. HAM Radio volunteers will also be connected with all the Emergency Operations Centers (1 State EOC and 12 DEOCs). HAM Radio Clubs will also be established in Educational Institutions.

15. Monitoring and Implementation

15.1 The State Executive Committee (SEC) constituted under the Disaster Management Act 2005 under the Chairmanship of Chief Secretary will monitor implementation of the Scheme. The SEC will be empowered to take all necessary measures, give clarification and financial sanctions, as may be required, from time to time.



Declaration Form

For Registration of HAM Radio Operator Seeking Subsidy from Himachal Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority (HPSDMA)

1. Personal Details

- Full Name: _____
- Father's/Mother's Name: _____
- Date of Birth: _____
- Gender: _____
- Address: _____

*Paste Latest
Photograph*

District: _____ Pin code: _____

- Mobile Number: _____
- Email ID: _____

2. HAM Radio License Details

- License Grade (General / Restricted): _____
- License Number: _____
- Date of Issue: _____
- Issuing Authority: _____

3. Declaration for Eligibility

I, the undersigned, hereby declare that:

1. I am a permanent resident of Himachal Pradesh.
 2. I have successfully cleared the HAM Radio Licensing Examination conducted by the **Wireless Planning & Coordination (WPC) Wing**, Ministry of Communications, Government of India.
 3. I have received a valid license to operate as a HAM Radio Operator.
 4. I am applying for subsidy under the HPSDMA scheme for promoting (Amateur (HAM) and Community Radio for “Alternative Communication during Emergencies” to support the purchase of HAM Radio equipment.
 5. I shall make available use the HAM Radio equipment during emergency communication, disaster response, and community service, as per the direction of SDMA, DDMA or state Government, as the case may be.
 6. I undertake to make myself available for training, drills, and emergency duties as and when required by the concerned District Disaster Management Authority (DDMA) / HPSDMA.
 7. I shall not misuse the equipment for any commercial or unlawful activity.
 8. I shall maintain and operate the equipment in compliance with the applicable rules and regulations of WPC and HPSDMA.
-

4. Bank Details (for Subsidy Transfer)

- **Bank Name:** _____
 - **Branch:** _____
 - **Account Holder Name:** _____
 - **Account Number:** _____
 - **IFSC Code:** _____
-

5. Documents Attached (Please tick ✓)

- ☐ Copy of HAM Radio License
 - ☐ Copy of Aadhaar Card / Domicile Certificate
 - ☐ Recent Passport Size Photograph
 - ☐ Cancelled Cheque / First Page of Passbook
 - ☐ Copy of Equipment Purchase Receipt
-

6. Signature and Verification

I hereby declare that the information provided above is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. If any information is found to be false or misleading at any stage, I shall be liable for legal action and refund of the subsidy amount to the DM Cell, Department of Revenue.

Signature of the Applicant: _____

Name: _____

Date: _____

Place: _____

For Official Use Only

(To be filled by DMC - HPSDMA)

- Application Received on: _____
- Verified by: _____
- Remarks: _____
- Approved / Not Approved: _____
- Signature: _____
- Date: _____



**Disaster Management Cell, Department of
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